Newspapers.com by Ancestry
https://www.newspapers.com/image/500856318/

Downloaded on Oct 4, 2024

4 firms to revive Cowichan

The old Sunro mine at Jordan River, near Sooke, Vancover Island, is getting another injection of capital by a group of companies who say they intend to reactivate it.

The Sunro property is owned by Cominco Ltd. but has been held on lease since early in 1961 and operated intermittently since that time. The original lease was obtained by Cowichan Copper Co. Ltd., whose operations were attended by misfortune from that time.

Cowichan has since lost its identity and the lease is held by Crownex International Ltd. through a subsidiary Dison Development Ltd.

Newcomers on the scene, announced Thursday, are Pechiney Development Ltd., susidiary of Pechiney (France) Ltee, and Aumas, Fergusson Wild Ltd., a firm of metal brokers.

The announcement was made by David D. Martin, general manager of Aumas, Fergusson Wild.

The four companies, Pechiney, Aumas, Crownex and Dison have signed an agreement, subject to the approval of all regulatory bodies, to reactivate the mine.

Pechiney and Aumas will purchase from Crownex 50 per cent of the outstanding stock of Dison for $500,000. This initial sum will be expended to finance development of the mine towards production. (It has a 1,500-ton mill installed

After the initial $500,000 has been expanding Pechiney, Aumas and Crownex will provide equally additional funds as required. Management and control will be in the hands of Pechiney and it is the stated intention to restore production early in 1971.

Pechiney is the second largest company in France and has worldwide interests in mining, metals and chemicals. Its Canadian headquarters is in Vancouver.

Aumas will be the company's exclusive marketing agent for concentrates.

The Sunro mine was originally two properties, called Sunloch and Gabbro, which had been developed by Cominco, formerly Consolidated Mining & Smelting Co. of Canada Ltd. Copper had been discovered there in 1915.

A lease arrangement was made early in 1961 by O. G. MacDonald, then president of Cowichan Copper. This company had successfully mined out its Blue Grouse orebody at Cowichan Lake. Its mill was moved to Sunro and installed underground.

The mine operated from July 1961 until December 1963 when the Jordan River broke through and flooded the underground workings.

Production was restored in December 1965 with assistance of Aetna Investment Corp. (formerly Sheep Creek Mines). Aetna, however, pulled out in September 1966. Aetna had made loans totalling $950,000 to Cowichan and, during the period, had sold its Cowichan shares for a profit of $300,000.

Cowichan by this time had debts of $2.5 million and the creditors accepted a proposal for reduction and deferment.

In April 1967 MacDonald restored limited production, with financial assistance from E. C. Dobell, who is now vice-president of Crownex. Dobell, through conversion of his advances into shares and after lawsuits, got control of Cowichan. He was voted into office as president Sept. 9, 1968.

At a shareholders meeting held Oct. 25, 1968, Cowichan's name was changed to Cerna Copper Mines Ltd. and its capital rolled back one for five.

The mine was shut down in November 1968

In October 1969, Corownex International Ltd. took over Cerna Copper on a share exchange of one Crownex for four Cerna. President of Crownex is Sidney B. Fowlds of Burnaby, vice-president of Dobell and treasurer is Dr. Frank M. Hall.

New books

The Imperfect Union, by J. Hutchinson.

Foreign Investment and Industrialization in Singapore, by H. Hughes.

GALIANO ISLAND
50 ACRES
South end, well treed, on gov't road with power and telephone. Sloping with view towards Vancouver. Approved for 4-lot subdivision. Private sale, $47,500. Phone 943-2615, Vancouver.

We look after th
repairs, deprecia
and licence fees

So how do you get

PACIFIC GMC LIMITED

With just one
down to Pac
how leasing
be a lot easie
– whether it's
you do is th
And it's your

BROADWAY
AT NANAIMO
AL 5-1111

Copyright © 2024 Newspapers.com. All Rights Reserved.